

OVER THE YEARS

In 1996, General Motors' launch of the GM OnStar in Cadillac marked the automotive industry's first big step toward connected cars, blending cutting-edge tech with vehicles. Luxury brands like BMW, Mercedes, and Audi quickly followed, and by the late 2010s, smartphones and mobile internet brought even more advanced connected car systems into play.

Today, software-as-a-service (SaaS) has come a long way. With Generative Artificial Intelligence (Gen AI) and the Internet of Things (IoT), connected cars now offer more than just real-time navigation and infotainment. They include vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communication and advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS), like adaptive cruise control, lane-keeping assist, and automatic emergency braking. These features use sensors and cameras to boost safety and prevent accidents.

Connectivity in a vehicle offers multiple levels of confidence. "It provides security through safety features, utility through payment options, and entertainment, including access to the Play Store. This comprehensive stack helps integrate connectivity into the mainstream of a consumer's life," says Gaurav Gupta, Deputy Managing Director of JSW MG Motors India.

112 |



"As we move forward, the penetration of connected cars will continue to grow rapidly"

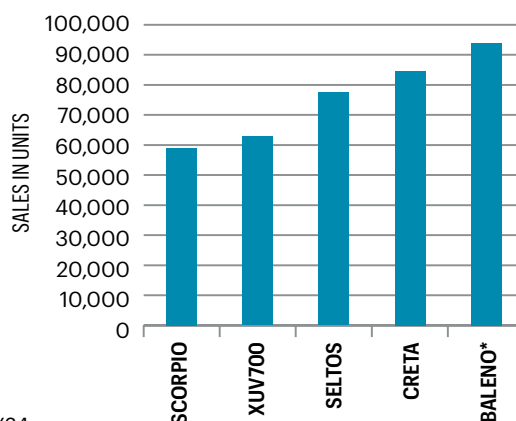
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SUVs IN THE LEAD

- In the Top 5 connected car models by sales volumes, only one is not an SUV
- Among carmakers, Maruti is in the lead, followed closely by Hyundai and Toyota

*NOT AN SUV; DATA FOR FY24
SOURCE JATO DYNAMICS

TOP MODELS



According to a report by the revenue impact and advisory company, MarketsandMarkets, the domestic connected car market is expected to grow at a CAGR of 22.2%, from \$9.8 billion in 2019 to reach \$32.5 billion by 2025.

COMING TO INDIA

In 2015, after Honda Cars India introduced its flagship connected car feature, Honda Connect, several automakers began integrating technology into the domestic automotive space. In 2019, South Korean automaker Hyundai introduced its connected car technology, Bluelink, in the flagship sedan, Verna. The same year, JSW MG Motors India

(formerly known as MG Motors India), identifying itself as an auto-technology brand, introduced the MG i-Smart technology in the MG Hector.

According to Gupta, introducing this feature was a game changer for the company. "That was when many consumers and the auto industry got a taste of a car with an embedded SIM, providing numerous features in the connected space," he notes.

According to many experts, connected cars as a concept is something Indian automakers have been quite excited about. In fact, over the years, several carmakers have taken significant strides in integrating connected car technology.

Moreover, as the market has grown, the features present in a connected car have grown too. Tata Motors' connected car platform, iRA, for instance, provides features such as remote vehicle control, real-time tracking, and vehicle health monitoring.

"As we move forward, the penetration of connected cars will continue to grow, alongside advancements in autonomous